MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FILE, VISIBLE INDEX, BOOK UNIT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a lightweight, portable, card book, index file with replaceable pocket assemblies.

1.2 Classification. The items covered by this specification shall be as follows (see 6.2 and 6.4).

Item 1 - Complete visible index file.
Item 2 - Replacement pocket assembly.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING & MATERIALS (ASTM)

D-570 - Water Absorption of Plastics.
D-638 - Tensile Properties of Plastics.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing & Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

TECHNICAL ASSOCIATION OF THE PULP AND PAPER INDUSTRY (TAPPI)

T-403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T-414 - Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper.
T-451 - Rigidity, Stiffness and Softness of Paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 1 Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the procurement document, the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.2).

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Book covers inside flaps and center leaf. Book covers (3.3.1), inside flaps (3.3.2) and the center leaf (3.3.3) shall be fabricated from either plastic or plastic coated material with all edges smooth and rounded. The minimum finished thicknesses of the materials shall be: book covers, 3/32 inch; inside flaps, 1/32 inch; and center leaf, 1/64 inch. The finish on the book covers, inside flaps and center leaf shall show no evidence of wear or any other defect when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.2 Back plate The back plate (3.3.4.1) shall be fabricated from fiberboard with a minimum thickness of 0.025 inches.

3.2.3 Pocket body. The material used in fabricating the pocket body (3.3.4.2.1) shall conform to the requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.4.3, 4.4.4.1 and 4.4.4.2.

3.2 4 Interlocking lug. The material used in fabricating the interlocking lug (3.3.4.2.2) shall conform to the requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4.2.

3.2.5 Pocket tip. The material used in fabricating the pocket tip (3.3.4.2.3) shall conform to the requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.4.4.2.

3.2.6 Signals The material used in fabricating the signals (3.3.5) shall conform to the requirements of table I when tested as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.4.4.2 and 4.4.4.3.

3.3 Construction. Each complete visible index file (Item I) shall consist of two book covers (3.3.1) (one front and one rear), two inside flaps (3.3.2), a center leaf (3.3.3), two removable pocket assemblies (3.3.4) (Item 2), and one hundred and ten signals (3.3.5) With the file in the closed position, it shall be 9-1/8 inches wide and 13-3/4 inches long. With the file in the opened position, it shall be 20 inches wide and 13-3/4 inches long. All dimensions in this paragraph are nominal dimensions. The book covers, inside flaps and center leaf shall all be the same color. This design shall be as shown in figure 1.

3.3.1 Book cover. Each book cover shall have a pocket, 1-1/2 ± 1/4 inches high, extending the full width of the bottom edge for supporting the bottom edge of the back plate (3.3.4.1). The inside top section of each book cover shall have a flexible hinged flap which shall be capable of supporting the inside flap (3.3.2), the back plate, and the pocket assemblies (see figure 1). The inside flap, the back plate, and the pocket assemblies shall be attached to the flexible hinged flap with removable, reusable fasteners. The front and rear covers shall be joined at the center with a flexible hinge. The hinge shall allow the covers to fold backwards so that the outside of each cover touches. The top hinged flap and the center hinge shall show no evidence of cracking, splitting or tearing when tested as specified in 4.4.6.

3.3.2 Inside flap. The inside flaps shall cover the top pocket of each pocket assembly, excluding the lower identification edge, and shall be attached to the flexible hinged flap at the top of the cover to allow it to lift to grant access to the pocket area. The inside flap, on the left cover, shall have a 1-1/2 ± 1/4 inch high pocket extending the full width at the bottom.

3.3.3 Center leaf. The center leaf shall be located between the two pocket assemblies. The leaf shall be connected to the book cover assembly by means of a flexible hinge. The center leaf shall be capable of entirely covering either pocket assembly when the covers are in the fully opened position. The hinge shall show no evidence of cracking, splitting or tearing when tested as specified in 4.4.6

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Material requirements.

Characteristics	Requirements			
	Pocket body	Interlocking lug	Pocket tip	Signal
Absorption, Water, 24 hrs. maximum %				10
Color	Optional	Similar to pocket body	Transparent	See 3.3.5
Elongation, minimum %				
Stiffness, minimum gram-centimetres machine direction cross direction	20 13	200 100		
Stock	100% Chemical wood fiber	Coated cardboard or plastic	Cellulose Acetate with non-glare face	Cellulose-Acetate of non-plasticized vinyl
Strength, Burst, Mullen, minimum grams	110			
Strength, Tear Elmendorf, minimum grams, machine and cross directions	245	600	95	95
Strength, Tensile, minimum lbs./in.				7000
Thickness, inches			0.009 ± 0.0005	0.010 ± 0.005

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.4 Pocket assembly (Item 2). Each pocket assembly shall consist of a back plate and twenty pockets.

3.3.4.1 Back plate. The back plate shall hold twenty pockets and shall be designed in accordance with figure 3.

3.3.4.2 Pocket Each pocket shall consist of a pocket body, an interlocking lug and a pocket tip. Pocket dimensions shall be in accordance with figure 2.

3.3.4.2.1 Pocket body. Double diagonal cuts shall be provided near the top corners to accommodate an 8 by 6 inch card on both the front and back of the pocket. Diagonal die cuts to hold 3 by 5 inch and 4 by 6 inch cards, die cuts to accommodate title inserts, a center notch at the bottom edge for a sliding signal and notches in the lower corners to allow lateral movement of the tip shall also be provided. The top of the pocket body shall be equipped with a die cut "hinge". A similar die cut "hinge" may also be provided at the bottom of the pocket.

3.3.4.2.2 Interlocking lug. The interlocking lug shall be stapled along the upper edge of the pocket body as shown in figure 2 so that the arms of the back plate (3.3.4.1) may be inserted between the interlocking lug and the pocket body. The staples and the interlocking lug shall be so located at the top of the pocket as to insure a uniform 5/16 inch exposure of the pocket tips (3.3.4.2.3) when the pockets are in place on the back plate. The staples shall be formed from a corrosion-resisting metal.

3.3.4.2.3 Pocket tip. The front upper edge of the tip shall be flattened upon itself to present a smooth edge for inserting cards and signals (see figure 2).

3.3.5 Signals. One hundred and ten signals, 1/2 $\pm$ 1/16 inch wide and 7/8 $\pm$ 1/16 inch long, shall be provided in an envelope with each unit, for insertion in the plastic pocket tip when ready for use. The assortment of signals shall be as follows:

(a) 40 buff opaque, with double scallops, for "Bed Numbers".
(b) 40 green transparent, with double scallops, for "Doctor's Orders".
(c) 10 red, crimped, for "Seriously Ill".
(d) 10 blue, crimped, for "Hold Breakfast".
(e) 10 black, crimped, for "Pass".

3.4 Identification marking. The front outside cover of the index file shall be lettered in imitation gold leaf, to show the title of the unit in a four-line format, set up as follows:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NURSING SERVICE BOOK UNIT

DOCTOR'S ORDERS

AND

NURSING NOTES

The letters in the first line of the above title shall be 1/2 inch high. The letters in the remaining three lines shall be 3/8 inch high. One of the inner covers of the index file, and the pocket assembly (when procured separately) shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer. The lettering shall show no evidence of wear when the test of 4.4.5 is performed.

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Index files and pocket assemblies shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability. All burrs and sharp edges shall be removed from the index files and pocket assemblies.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

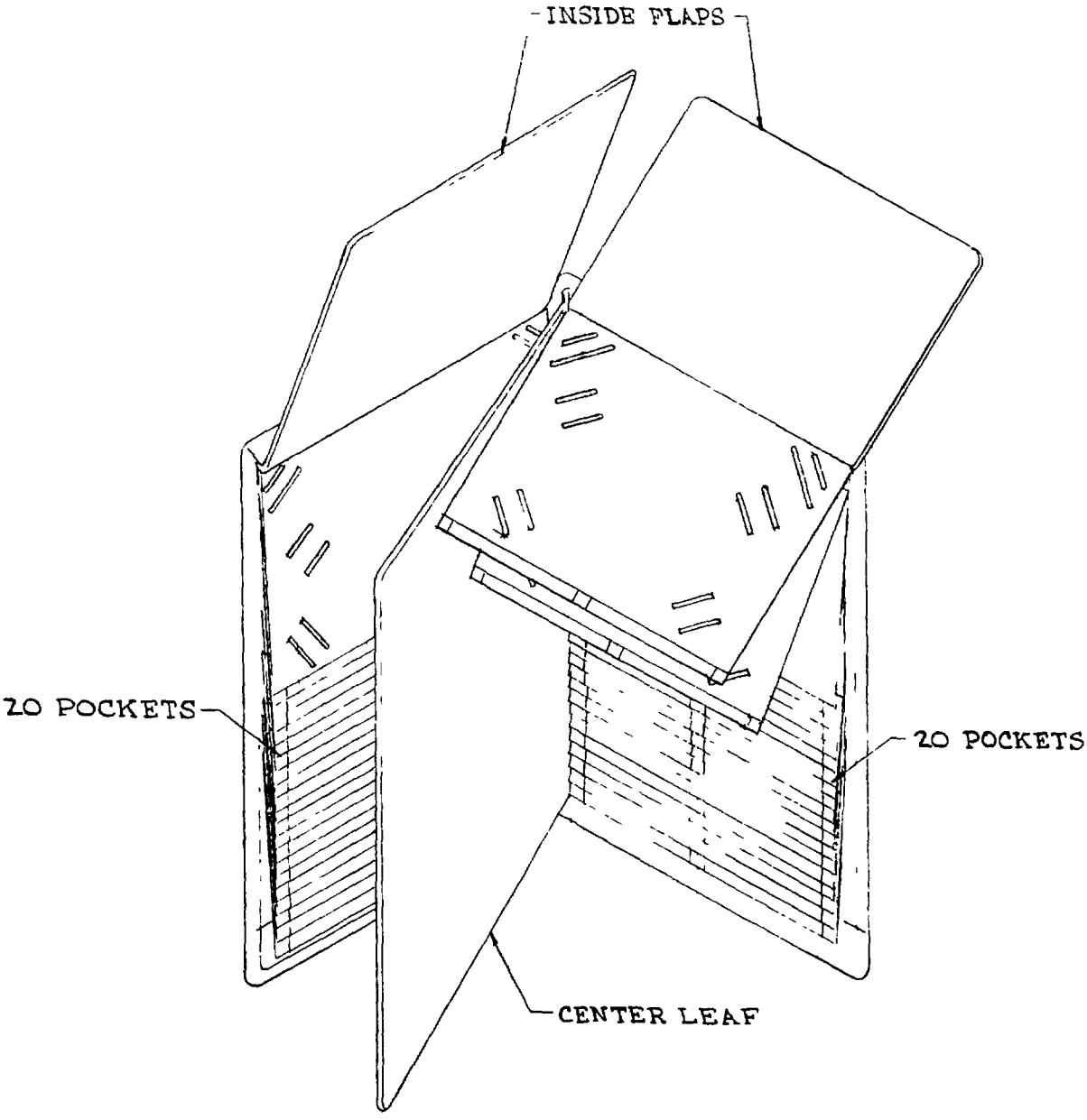


FIGURE 1. Book unit, visible index file

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

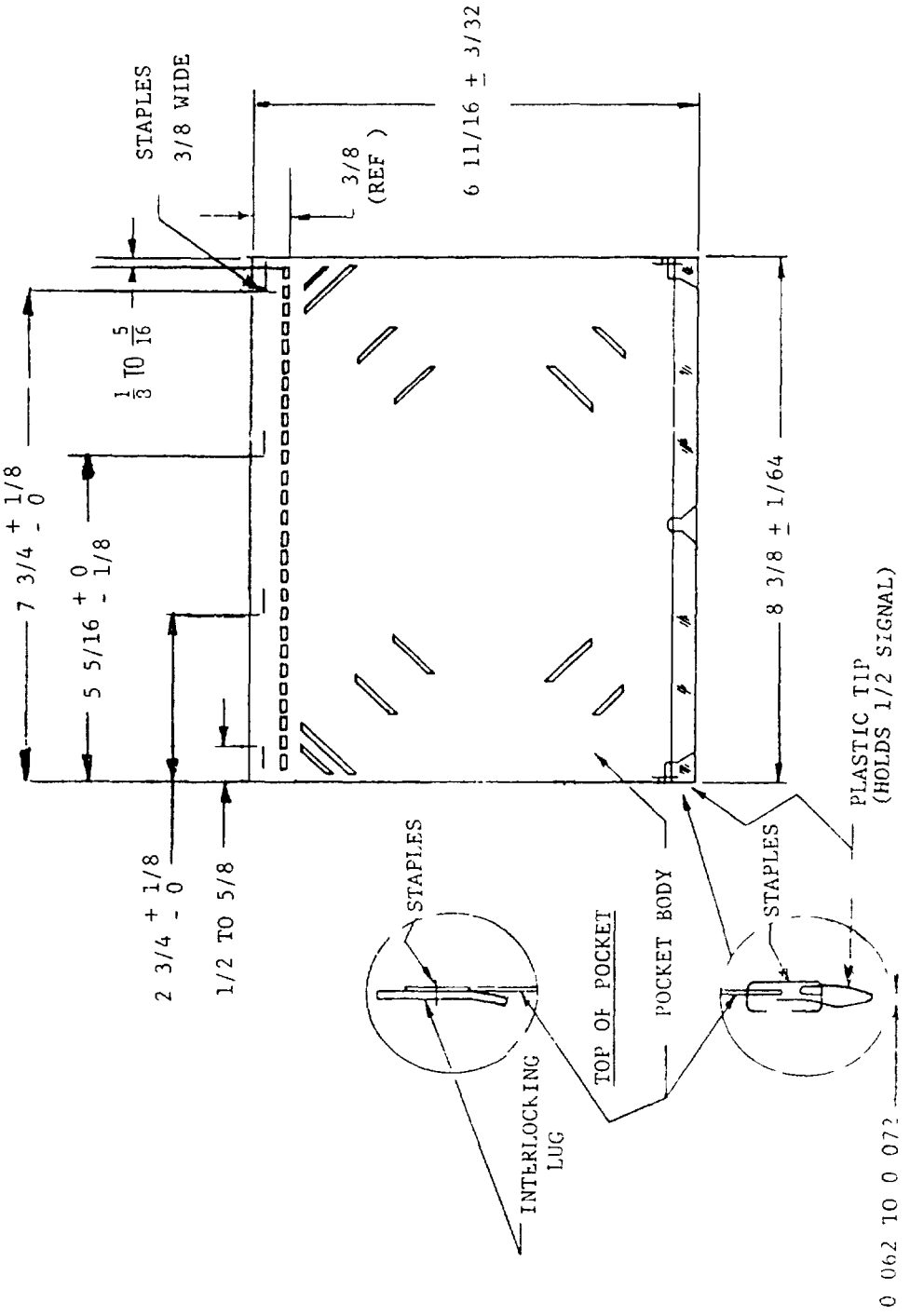
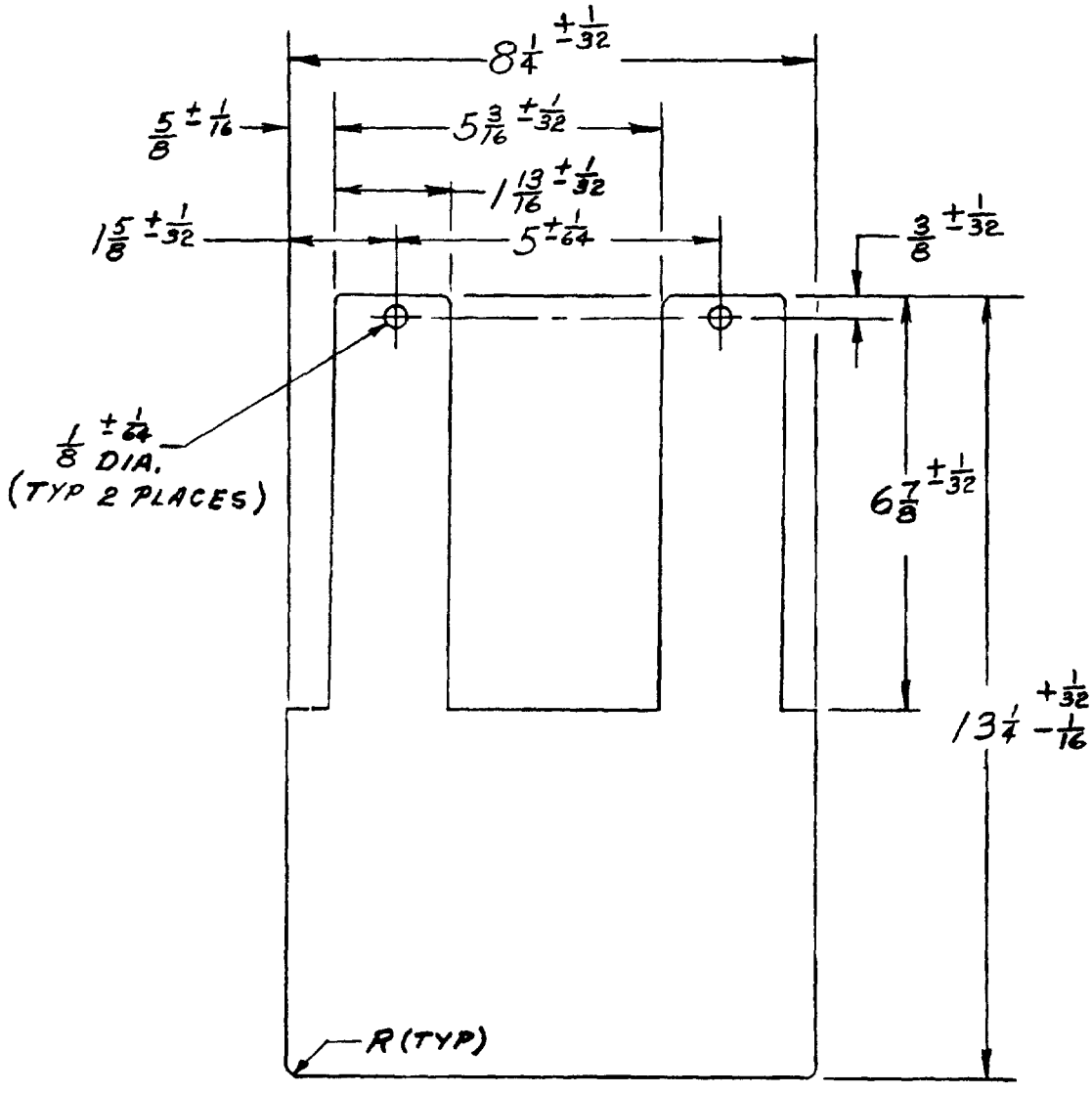


FIGURE 2. POCKET

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES

All dimensions are in inches.
Tolerances shall be non-cumulative.

FIGURE 3 Back plate

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.2.1.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on index files or pocket assemblies (see 6.2) when a first article sample is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.2.1.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall include the examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and table II. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one index file or one pocket assembly as specified in 6.2.

TABLE II. Sampling for examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	1.0
Total defects (Major and Minor combined)	II	4.0
For dimensional examination	S-1	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table III. Unless otherwise specified in the referenced ASTM and TAPPI standards the inspection level shall be S-1. The acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Sampling for tests.

Component (Unit of product)	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure
Pocket body	Stiffness	Table I	4.4.3
	Strength:		
	Burst	Table I	4.4.4.1
	Tear	Table I	4.4.4.2
Interlocking lug	Stiffness	Table I	4.4.3
	Strength:		
	Tear	Table I	4.4.4.2
Pocket tip	Strength:		
	Tear	Table I	4.4.4.2
Signals	Absorption,		
	Water	Table I	4.4.1
	Elongation	Table I	4.4.2
	Strength:		
	Tear	Table I	4.4.4.2
	Tensile	Table I	4.4.4.3
Index file (complete)	Wear:		
	resistance of		
	finish	3.2.1,	4.4.5
	Hinge flex-		
	ibility	3.3.1, 3.3.3	4.4.6

4.3 Examination. The index files or pocket assemblies (see 6.2) shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table IV. Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed below.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Not item and design specified.
102	Not free of cracks, holes, tears.
103	Any component missing, broken or otherwise unusable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects. (cont'd)

Categories	Defects
Minor	
201	Identification marking not present, complete, legible, correct.
202	Not clean, free of grease, oil dirt, other foreign matter.
203	Fasteners not tight, properly applied.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The index files or pocket assemblies (see 6.2) shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerances specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.3 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit, intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Absorption, water. The signals shall be tested for water absorption in a 24 hour period in accordance with ASTM Standard D-570.

4.4.2 Elongation. The signals shall be tested for elongation in accordance with ASTM Standard D-638.

4.4.3 Stiffness. The pocket body and the interlocking lug shall be tested for stiffness in accordance with TAPPI Standard T-451.

4.4.4 Strength.

4.4.4.1 Burst strength. The pocket body shall be tested for Mullen burst strength in accordance with TAPPI Standard T-403.

4.4.4.2 Tear strength. The pocket body, interlocking lug, pocket tip and the signals shall be tested for Elmendorf tear strength in accordance with TAPPI Standard T-414.

4.4.4.3 Tensile strength. The signals shall be tested for tensile strength in accordance with ASTM Standard D-638.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.5 Wear resistance of finish. The index file shall be slid along the full length of a 3 feet long piece of felt at least twenty (20) times for each of the surfaces tested below. Leaving the file in the closed position, the outside surface of both book covers shall be tested. The book covers shall then be folded backwards so that the outside of each cover touches. This allows access to the inside flaps and center leaf. The center leaf shall be folded over to cover one pocket assembly and the exposed surface of the center leaf shall be tested. With the center leaf in the same position the file shall be turned over and the exposed inside flap surface tested. The center leaf shall then be folded to cover the other pocket assembly and the remaining surface of the center leaf and the exposed surface of the remaining inside flap shall be tested.

4.4.6 Hinge flexibility. The hinge connecting the two book covers and the center leaf together and the hinge on each inside flap shall be tested by operating the hinge for at least fifty (50) flexing cycles. For the hinge connecting the book covers and the center leaf together one flexing cycle shall consist of the following:

a. Start with the index file in the closed position.
b Open the index file and fold the book covers so that the otuside of each cover touches.
c. Move the center leaf from one pocket assembly to the other and then back again.
d. Close index file as in a.

For the hinge on each inside flap, one flexing cycle shall consist of the following:

a. Start with the index file in a normal "opened book" position with the inside flap covering the pocket assembly.
b. Lift the bottom end of the inside flap and allow it to transcribe an arc of 180^{0}.
c. Bring the inside flap back to the position of covering the pocket assembly.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each unit of item 1 or item 2 shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of box shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Twelve (12) units of item 2 shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Box shall be closed as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. Intermediate package for item 1 is not required.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty-four (24) units of item 1 or seventy-two (72) units of item 2 shall be packed in an exterior container constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four (24) units of item 1 or seventy-two (72) units of item 2 shall be packed in an exterior container constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of box shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking. Each unit, intermediate package and exterior container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The visible index file and pocket assembly covered by this specification are intended for use by hospital ward nurses.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Item required (see 1.2).
c. National stock number (NSN).
d. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. First article if required (see 3.1, 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be tested under the appropriate provisions of the Armed Services Procurement Regulation. The contract or purchase order specifies the quantity, procedure for delivery and other specific instructions for inspection of the first article.

6.4 This specification covers the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog.

National Stock Number	Item Identification
7460-00-299-9492	File, Visible Index, Book Unit
7460-00-982-6792	Pocket Assembly, Visible Index File

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 7460-0001

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS. The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-F-37568 FILE, VISIBLE INDEX, BOOK UNIT

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS	CONTRACT NUMBER
	MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A ☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1 HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2 COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3 IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4 REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*	TELEPHONE NO
	DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 **1426**

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEFENSE SUPPLY AGENCY
DoD - 304



OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

HEADQUARTERS, DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
ATTN DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL MATERIEL, CODE ATT
2800 SOUTH 20TH STREET
PHILADELPHIA, PA 19101

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T11:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.